

# Leon Menzies

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## Technical Skills

**Programming & Backend:** PHP, Python, Node.js, Java, C++, MySQL, PostgreSQL

**Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (S3, EC2, CloudFront, SQS), Docker, Nginx, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, CircleCI, Bitbucket Pipelines)

**Testing & Quality:** Postman, Unit Testing, Regression Testing, SonarQube

**Frontend & Frameworks:** React, React Native, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, Ruby on Rails, Laravel, Express.js, Flask

**Core Strengths:** Rapidly adapts to new technologies, strong foundation in algorithms, system design, and secure API development

## Work Experience

### Software Engineer

June 2023 – Present

*VoPay International Inc.*

*Vancouver, BC*

- Played a key role in developing, enhancing, and maintaining a **high-performance, API-driven payment infrastructure** leveraging **PHP, MySQL, and AWS**.
- Architected and implemented scalable, resilient, and secure **cloud-based system architectures** using **AWS S3, EC2, CloudFront, and SQS**.
- Collaborated closely with the VP of Technology to align backend development efforts with strategic business objectives and deliver high-impact solutions.
- Implemented **static code analysis** with **SonarQube**, integrated into Bitbucket pipelines, improving code quality and reducing defects across projects.
- Developed robust, secure data management solutions in compliance with PCI DSS and SOC 2 regulatory standards.
- Designed and tested APIs using **Postman**, supporting automated regression testing and unit testing to ensure reliability and performance.
- Leveraged **AI-assisted development tools** (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and others) to accelerate routine coding tasks, increasing efficiency and freeing time for high-value system design.

### Full Stack Developer

Feb 2022– Mar 2023

*New Zealand Exchange*

*Wellington, NZ*

- Transformed multiple Ruby on Rails applications into modular, standalone APIs, implementing JWT authentication and enabling full CRUD functionality.
- Developed an Express API with Node.js to power a dashboard application for monitoring internal and external website performance, leveraging JavaScript's Promise object for concurrent HTTP requests to optimize response times.
- Engineered responsive and dynamic React front-end applications, utilizing React's DOM architecture to enhance rendering efficiency and deliver seamless user experiences across devices.
- Designed and implemented efficient algorithms in Ruby and JavaScript for data manipulation, significantly reducing request processing times.
- Orchestrated UAT, disaster recovery (DR), and production deployments through robust CI/CD pipelines, including CircleCI and GitHub Actions, ensuring seamless application delivery.
- Provided production support for live applications while managing the deployment of new products and features to meet customer needs effectively.

### Tester Intern

Nov 2021 – Feb 2022

*New Zealand Exchange*

*Wellington, NZ*

- Employed diverse testing methodologies, including regression, integration, automation, and manual testing, to comprehensively evaluate systems and ensure seamless end-to-end functionality.

## Education

**Victoria University of Wellington | Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**

Graduated Nov 2022

**Achievements:** Dean's list achievement every year with an overall GPA of 3.86/4

**Relative Coursework:** Engineering Mathematics, Clouds and Networking, Algorithms and Data Structures, Cybersecurity, Machine Learning, Concurrent Programming, Databases, Software Design, and System Programming.

## Project Highlights

### Macro Dash

- Built a full-stack dashboard app with a Python Flask API and MySQL backend, using SQLAlchemy ORM and JWT-based authentication.
- Developed a modular React-TypeScript frontend with reusable components and API integrations, including FRED economic data.
- Deployed on Linode with Ubuntu, Nginx, and Unicorn, serving the frontend as a static SPA.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines to streamline deployments, and added caching with session storage for improved performance.
- Features include real-time data visualizations, a drag-and-drop layout, and light/dark theming for a polished UX.

### Fitness App

- Built a cross-platform fitness app with React Native/Expo and a Python Flask backend, featuring secure JWT authentication and Sign In with Apple integration.
- Developed a personalized workout system with an onboard workflow, dynamic generated workout plans using AI, and real-time progress tracking.
- Implemented clean architecture and state management using Recoil, ensuring scalability and maintainability.